

ECON 220 – Global Economic Shifts
Winter 2025

Instructor Information	
Instructor	Muhebullah Karimzada
Contact Information	✉ karimzada@unbc.ca ☎ Phone: TBA
Office Location & Hours	Online 🕒 1:00 pm – 2:30 pm on Tuesday and Thursday or by appointment
Teaching Assistant	✉ TBA

Course Information	
Lectures	Available: on Monday and Wednesday at 2:00 pm
Course Format	Online (Asynchronous) – Zoom
Course Description	This course explores the concept of global economic shifts and how they impact regions such as Northern British Columbia (NBC). Topics include the effects of technological advancements, demographic changes, trade, environmental factors, and geopolitical dynamics on local and global economies. Using NBC as a case study, students will <u>analyze</u> how regions adapt to and leverage these global shifts for sustainable economic growth. The course will also examine Indigenous perspectives and the role of local communities in navigating economic transitions.
Course Learning Outcomes	At the end of the course, students should be able to • Define and understand global economic shifts. • Identify key global drivers such as technology, trade, and demographics. • Analyze the impacts of these shifts on Northern British Columbia's economy. • Evaluate strategies for balancing economic growth with sustainability. • Discuss the role of Indigenous communities in regional development.
Textbook	There is no required textbook for this course. The following are supplementary readings. • <u>Stiglitz</u>, J. E. (2002). <i>Globalization and Its Discontents</i>. • <u>Bowles</u>, P., & Wilson, M. (2015). <i>Resource Communities in a Globalizing Region</i>. • Prince Rupert Port Authority (2023). <i>Annual Reports</i>. • Additional readings will be provided via the course website (Moodle).
Additional Resources	Additional resources (e.g. lecture slides, practice problem sets) are posted on Moodle. Students are responsible for downloading and saving course material on Moodle before the access to their courses is shut off.

Evaluation & Assessments

Learning in this course results primarily from lectures, in-class discussions, home readings, and practice problem sets. Students learning and progress in this course will be evaluated on individual basis. Grades for this course will be calculated as follows:

<i>Assessment</i>	<i>Weight</i>	<i>Due Date</i>
<i>Term project and presentation</i>	30%	Final draft due on Mar 31 st , 2025
<i>Midterm exam 1</i>	15%	February 5 th , 2025
<i>Midterm exam 2</i>	15%	March 19 th , 2025
<i>Final Exam</i>	40%	TBA
<i>Total</i>	<i>100%</i>	

Course schedule by week

Week	Date	Topic	Readings
1	Jan 6 – 12	Introduction to Global Economic Shifts - What are global economic shifts? - Key drivers of global shifts (technology, trade, demographics)	Notes
2 & 3	Jan 13 - 26	The Impact of Technology on Global and Local Economies - Technological advancements and automation - Case studies on technology's role in reshaping industries in NBC	Notes
4 & 5	Jan 27 – Feb 9	Trade and Economic Integration - Free trade agreements and their impact on regional economies - NBC's position within the Asia-Pacific trade network	Notes
6	Feb 10 - 16	Environmental and Climate Changes - The global shift towards sustainability - The role of renewable energy and sustainable practices in NBC's development	Notes
Mid-Semester Break			

7	Feb 24 – Mar 2	Demographic Changes and their Economic Implications • Aging populations and labor force changes • Outmigration and youth retention in Northern BC	• Notes
8 & 9	Mar 3 - 16	Geopolitical Dynamics and Economic Shifts • Global trade tensions, sanctions, and their effects on NBC • NBC's reliance on international markets	• Notes
10	Mar 17 - 23	Indigenous Perspectives in Economic Development • Indigenous community involvement in resource development • Case study: Joint ventures and Indigenous-led projects	• Notes
11	Mar 24 - 30	Case Study: Prince Rupert Port • Growth of the port and its economic significance • Environmental and community impacts	• Notes
12	Mar 31 – Apr 6	NBC's Economic Challenges and Opportunities • Diversifying the economy beyond resource extraction • Strategies for sustainable growth and development	• Notes

Please Note:

1. For some chapters selected portions will be covered as a part of the course material.
2. If a student misses a lecture for any reason, it is student's responsibility to obtain class lecture notes and other relevant material.
3. Details of the term project and presentation will be discussed during the first week of lectures, and all relevant information will be posted on Moodle.
4. There will be no make-up midterms.
5. If a midterm exam is missed, given proper documentation, 50% of the missed midterm weight will be transferred to the other midterm and the remaining 50% of the weight will be allocated to the final exam. Students must write at least one midterm exam.
6. All exams, midterms and final, are individual and closed-book.
7. Both the midterms and the final exam will consist of a mix of short answer questions, analytical problems, numerical calculations, mathematical derivations, true-false, multiple choice, and fill-in-the-blank questions, and will draw on material covered in the lectures.
8. Your grades on midterms will be posted on Moodle. Please immediately report to the instructor any discrepancy between the posted and actual grades.
9. Only the Registrar's Office can issue final grades. Hence, marks for the final exam will not be posted on Moodle.
10. You are encouraged to contact course instructor or course TA for any questions on the course material and outlines, evaluation scheme, and the final exam.

Artificial Intelligence (AI)

Use of generative AI is NOT allowed in this course, unless specifically authorized by the instructor. Please consult with the instructor if any clarification is needed. General guidance on the acceptability of using generative AI at UNBC can be found [here](#).

Plagiarism

Plagiarism is a misrepresentation of information that can result in a misattribution of credit, up to and including representing someone else's work as your own. When you incorporate the words, ideas, graphics, or other products from someone else's work into your projects, you must give credit by providing a citation and reference to the source work.

It is your responsibility to:

1. Familiarize yourself with and understand the information on [plagiarism](#) provided by the Academic Success Centre,
2. And the UNBC policy on Student Conduct, plagiarism and other academic offenses, as described in the UNBC Undergraduate calendar.

Grading System - Undergraduate Assessments

<i>Grade Point</i>	<i>Letter Grade</i>	<i>Percentage</i>	<i>Definition/Standing</i>
4.33	A+	90 -100%	Excellent
4.00	A	85-89.9%	
3.67	A-	80-84.9%	
3.33	B+	77-79.9%	Good
3.00	B	73-76.9%	
2.67	B-	70-72.9%	
2.33	C+	70-72.9%	Satisfactory
2.00	C	63-66.9%	
1.67	C-	60-62.9%	Marginal
1.33	D+	57-59.9%	
1.00	D	53-56.9%	
0.67	D-	50-62.9%	
0.00	F	0-49.9%	Failure

Student Services

University students often encounter setbacks from time to time that can impact academic performance. If you experience difficulties and need assistance, it's important to reach out. The following resources are available **free** to all students at UNBC and can help address mental, emotional, or physical health concerns:

General IT & Moodle Support

IT Services can assist you with accessing your UNBC account or Moodle, please email support@unbc.ca or visit their [Support for Students](#) page. If you have specific questions or errors while uploading assignments, using video, Kaltura etc. contact the Centre for Teaching Learning & Technology at ctl@unbc.ca.

Academic Advising

For questions regarding course load, understanding your degree requirements or your GPA please reach out to Academic Advising located in the Enrollment Services Room 7-702.

Webpage: [Student Advising](#)

Phone: 250-960-6306

Email: advising@unbc.ca

The Academic Success Centre (ASC)

The Academic Success Centre provides students with free access to academic support services: Tutoring (by appointment, asynchronous online, or drop-in), personalized study skills assessments and peer-led course supports. ASC services are available in person (room 5-139) at the Prince George Campus and online

Webpage: [Academic Success Centre](#)

Phone: 250-960-6367 | Toll Free 1-888-440-3440

Email: asc@unbc.ca

Access Resource Centre (ARC)

The Access Resource Centre (ARC) provides services to students with documented health conditions and/or disabilities. ARC staff are available to meet with you to determine which academic accommodation can be put in place to support you in achieving their academic goals, provide referrals, and help advocate for you.

Webpage: [Access Resource Centre](#)

Phone: 250-960-5682 | Toll Free 1-888-960-5682

Email: arc@unbc.ca

UNBC Counselling Services

Offers counseling for all students as well as access to First Nations Counseling Services

Offers health and general services that support academic success and personal wellbeing of students

Webpage: [UNBC Counselling Services](#)

Phone: 250-960-6369

Email: wellness@unbc.ca

Crisis Centre for Northern BC (24/7)

If you are feeling overwhelmed, depressed, confused, suicidal, or just needing someone to listen to, the crisis line provides emotional support, suicide intervention and referral information. If you are unable to meet course expectations due to mental health reasons, please discuss your situation with your instructor, counsellor or/and an academic advisor.

Webpage: <https://crisis-centre.ca/>

Phone: Northern BC: [1-888-562-1214](tel:1-888-562-1214) | Youth Support: [1-888-564-8336](tel:1-888-564-8336) | Anywhere in BC: [1-800-784-2433](tel:1-800-784-2433)

UNBC SAFE app

UNBC SAFE features emergency contacts, services, information and safety tips. Emergency messaging can be sent to you via Push notifications when enabled. Download the App [here](#).

UNBC Athletics

Please note that students involved in University Athletics will be required to notify the instructor at least two weeks in advance of any official athletics commitments (e.g., games, travel) that conflict with due dates.

Food Security

We understand the cost of living is higher than ever, and it's hard to learn when you're hungry. The [NUGSS Food Bank](#) (located in the NUGSS office in Building 6) is open to all students.